



campusMate

One platform for campus life.

The student platform for university campuses

DOCUMENT

Product Overview

VERSION

1.0

DATE

24 July 2026

FOUNDED BY

Delton & Freddy

THE PROBLEM

What we identified

Student life runs on constant informal exchange — buying, selling, tutoring, studying together. None of it has a safe, organised home. We looked at how students on our own campus actually do these things today, and found four problems. None of them are unique to one university.

01 Trading happens in places built for strangers

Students sell through WhatsApp groups, noticeboards and public marketplaces open to anyone. There is no way to confirm the person on the other side is even a student, and nothing connects a seller to a track record.

02 Meetups are the dangerous part

A deal agreed online ends with two strangers meeting somewhere — often an address one of them chose, frequently off campus. That single moment is where fraud, theft and personal-safety risk concentrate, and it is completely unmanaged.

03 Academic help depends on luck

Finding a tutor for a difficult module, or someone to study with, comes down to who you happen to know. Students who did well and could tutor have no way to be found, and students who are struggling have no reliable place to look.

04 Every year, value is thrown away

Final-year students leave campus with fridges, kettles, desks, textbooks and appliances they no longer need — at the exact moment a new intake arrives needing all of it. With no channel between them, goods get dumped or sold far below value while newcomers overpay elsewhere.

THE RESPONSE

Why campusMate was born

Students were already trading, tutoring and helping each other every day. The activity was never the problem — the missing piece was a place to do it where you know who you are dealing with, and where you meet.

campusMate was founded by **Delton** and **Freddy**, two second-year Computer Science students at the University of Johannesburg, to fix this on their own campus. Rather than build another open marketplace, they built a closed one: a platform only verified students can enter, where every exchange is arranged to happen face to face at a known point on campus.

That one constraint changes everything downstream. Because each campus is its own closed community, reputation means something — a rating follows a real student across every trade and tutoring session. Because meetups happen at approved campus points, the riskiest moment becomes the safest. And because the whole student body is in one place, the yearly churn of leavers and newcomers finally has a channel to flow through.

What started as a fix for one campus applies to every campus. campusMate is built to run for **any university** — each institution gets its own verified student community and its own approved meetup points, on the same platform.

THE PLATFORM

What campusMate does

Four services on one verified account. A student moves between them without leaving the platform.

Marketplace

List anything from a bar fridge to a textbook. Browse by category and price, message the seller, and agree a campus meetup point to complete the handover.

Tutors

Students who did well in a module offer tutoring in it. Learners search by module code, compare rates and reviews, and book sessions.

Study partners

Find someone taking the same modules to prepare with. Match on module, year and campus, then agree where and when to meet.

Communities

Join groups around a residence, a faculty, a society or an interest — the social layer that keeps students coming back between trades.

ACCOUNTS

Who uses it

Every student account can both buy and sell — these are modes a student moves between, not separate sign-ups. Administrators are staff accounts.

STUDENT **Buyer profile**

- Browse listings, tutors and study partners
- Message a seller and agree a meetup
- Confirm the handover once done
- Leave a review and rating
- Report a listing or a person

STUDENT **Seller profile**

- Create listings with photos and price
- Offer tutoring by module and set a rate
- Accept or decline meetup requests
- Build a public rating and review history
- Track active, sold and expired listings

STAFF **Administrator**

- Verify and approve student accounts
- Review reports and moderate listings
- Suspend or ban abusive accounts
- Manage approved campus meetup points
- Oversee categories and communities

SAFETY MODEL

How a safe trade works

This sequence is the heart of the product. Each step removes a way the exchange could go wrong.

1 **Both people are verified students**

Accounts are approved against student credentials before anyone can list or buy. There are no anonymous profiles.

2 **The buyer checks the seller's history**

Every profile carries its rating, completed trades and written reviews. Reputation is visible before contact.

3 They agree a campus meetup point

Meetups are chosen from approved, well-lit, public spots on campus — never a private address, never off campus.

4 The meetup is logged

The agreed point and time are recorded against the trade, so there is a record of who arranged to meet whom, and where.

5 Both confirm the handover

Buyer and seller each mark the trade complete. A trade only counts once both sides agree it happened.

6 They review each other

Ratings feed straight back into the reputation the next student will see — and reports escalate to an administrator.

TRUST & MODERATION

Keeping the platform clean

MECHANISM	WHAT IT DOES	WHO ACTS
Verification	Confirms a person is a registered student at their university before they can trade	Administrator
Reviews & ratings	Build a public reputation from real completed trades	Students
Reports	Flag a listing, a message or a person for review	Students
Meetup points	Restrict handovers to public, known locations on campus	Administrator
Suspension & bans	Remove repeat offenders and fraudulent accounts	Administrator
Listing moderation	Take down prohibited, unsafe or misleading items	Administrator

ROADMAP

How we get there

Build the trading core first — it is the reason students sign up. Layer the academic and social services on top of verified accounts and reviews once that base exists.

PHASE ONE

The trading core

- Student verification and profiles
- Listings, search and messaging
- Campus meetup points
- Reviews, ratings and reports
- Admin moderation tools

PHASE TWO

Academic services

- Tutor profiles by module
- Session booking
- Study-partner matching
- Module-based search

PHASE THREE

Community and scale

- Communities and group posting
- Notifications and saved searches
- Graduation-season campaigns
- Onboarding additional universities

FOUNDERS

Who built it

campusMate was founded by **Delton** and **Freddy**, two second-year Computer Science students at the University of Johannesburg who built it to solve the problem on their own campus — then designed it so any university could use it. The two rings in our mark are exactly that: two students, linked.



Delton

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